

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager II, Payroll Product Activation.*

Positioning, Product manager with 13 years in regulated, infrastructure-heavy domains who compresses complex onboarding workflows into scalable, automation-first product systems.

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§ WHY DEEL

Deel's Payroll Product Activation team is solving a problem I recognise precisely: onboarding workflows that are, by nature, highly variable across customers, jurisdictions, and entity configurations, and that have historically scaled only through headcount. The posting's framing of "compressing months-long, manual processes into something that scales intelligently across thousands of customers" is exactly the class of infrastructure problem I have spent the last several years working on, from public-sector ETL pipelines to insurance claims automation to AI and data platform delivery. What makes this role technically interesting is that the variation is not a bug to eliminate; it is the constraint around which the automation must be designed. *That is precisely the kind of systems problem where judgment compounds faster than process.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case coverage
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming and boilerplate reduction
- **Cursor**, codebase navigation and refactors
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes and stakeholder demos

- **GPT**, research synthesis and document drafting
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow orchestration
 - **Gamma.app**, executive-facing roadmap and strategy decks
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HILBERTP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built zero-to-one with LLM agents across the full funnel.

- Matches construction firms with workers anonymously until payment commitment, removing the intermediary headhunter from the transaction entirely.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, with LLM agents handling qualification, scheduling, and follow-up so one operator runs the day-to-day.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; onboarding flow iterated from user escalations and drop-off signals.
 - Directly relevant to Deel: demonstrates the ability to ship a multi-sided onboarding workflow with compliance constraints and variable customer configurations under solo resource constraints.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT DEEL

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow customer onboarding calls and escalation queues, map the current entity-setup and payroll-run activation flows end-to-end in Miro, and identify where variation is handled manually versus where it is already encoded in configuration, before touching the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Slice the variation.

Segment the customer variation space into clusters by entity type, jurisdiction count, and contract mix; score each cluster by volume and manual-effort cost to identify which automations unlock the most throughput per engineering quarter.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Align with engineering on the first automation slice, set the measurement frame (time-to-first-payroll-run, manual-touch rate per activation), ship, and run a structured retrospective against those metrics before the next planning cycle.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Deel Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Product Manager II role on the Payroll Product Activation team. My background is in regulated, infrastructure-heavy product environments, defence AI platforms, public-sector analytics, insurance SaaS, fintech, and the common thread across all of them has been designing systems that handle high customer variation without scaling headcount linearly alongside it.

The specific problem your team describes, compressing a months-long, manual payroll onboarding process into something that runs intelligently across thousands of entities, jurisdictions, and contract configurations, maps directly to work I have done at scale. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS programme, where I had to balance compliance rigour, multinational stakeholder constraints, and a velocity mandate simultaneously. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD and cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes, and I redirected the product strategy mid-flight when workflow instrumentation showed that the UI-led approach was recording zero real usage. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I drove an ETL modernisation with Dagster and dbt that cut quarterly data-update time by roughly 75%, while simultaneously carrying a full UI relaunch and a container migration. Both engagements required exactly the pragmatic trade-off muscle the posting describes: knowing which problems need perfect solutions and which need "good enough" ones.

I am comfortable owning the full product development lifecycle in high-velocity, ambiguous environments. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a roadmap a five-person team could not deliver, cut it to the 10% of features that moved the agreed success measures, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. At EMIL Group I rebuilt a fractured 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads, which stopped an engineer exodus and

unblocked a Claims Center launch that had no internal precedent. Both situations required making decisions with incomplete information, communicating uncertainty clearly to stakeholders above and below, and course-correcting quickly when reality diverged from the plan.

On the AI and automation side, my daily stack includes Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, and n8n for agentic workflow orchestration. I use these to move faster in discovery and prototyping, and I apply the same LLM-agent design principles to product architecture decisions. The Payroll Product Activation team's stated direction of AI-first, autonomous action on setup workflows is not a direction I am learning toward, it is where I already operate.

I am based in Berlin, an EU citizen with no visa requirement, and fully available for remote work within the EMEA timezone. I would welcome the opportunity to talk through how my experience maps to the specific onboarding automation challenges your team is navigating.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Senior Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated, infrastructure-heavy environments, defence AI, public-sector analytics, fintech, insurance, healthcare. I own vision, roadmap, and execution in cross-functional teams, balance compliance precision with delivery velocity, and apply AI-native tooling as a structural part of how I work. For roles in payroll, HR, or financial infrastructure SaaS, I bring direct experience compressing manual, multi-stakeholder onboarding workflows into automated, measurable systems.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

Platform and SaaS Delivery: AI-powered automation strategy, onboarding workflow design, multi-stakeholder alignment, fintech and regulated-industry product execution, cross-functional team leadership up to 15+ engineers and data scientists.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.

Governance and Compliance: GDPR/DSGVO, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

Owned AI and data platform for the FCAS programme across multinational teams of 15+ engineers and data scientists; introduced GitOps with ArgoCD, cutting rollout from days to 30 minutes; redirected strategy from UI-led to developer-code-first after workflow instrumentation, lifting pipeline runs 200%.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Cut quarterly ETL update time by ~75% with Dagster and dbt; migrated bare-metal system to containers; introduced CI/CD test automation into Jenkins; Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE SAAS 2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to the top 10% of features by agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Integrated CGM interface: digital anamnesis time dropped from 30 to 5 minutes.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Rebuilt 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; stopped near-total engineer attrition. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut new-product time-to-market from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND
PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT IDENTITY 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING
2025-2026

Two-sided B2B marketplace, zero to one: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software; shipped three-layer product that installs in under two minutes; later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRITECH 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds: financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments platform; built from zero, acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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